

Prompt Engineering

Basic to Advanced

A Complete Learning Guide by AIMantraas

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INTRODUCTION

Core Concepts & Terminology

Before writing your first prompt, you need to understand what is actually happening when you talk to an AI. These four concepts form the foundation of everything that follows in this guide.

Prompt

The command you give to an AI system. It can be a question, instruction, or description. Everything you type is your prompt — and the quality of your prompt determines the quality of your answer.

AI (Artificial Intelligence)

A computer system designed to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence — understanding language, making decisions, solving problems, and generating content.

NLP (Natural Language Processing)

The technology that allows computers to read, understand, and respond in human languages like English or Hindi. NLP is what makes AI feel like a conversation.

LLM (Large Language Model)

The engine powering modern AI tools like ChatGPT and Claude. Trained on billions of pages of text, an LLM predicts and generates human-like responses based on the patterns it has learned.

REMEMBER THIS

Key Insight: The LLM is a pattern-matching engine. Your prompt is the pattern you give it. A vague pattern produces a vague answer. A specific, rich pattern produces a specific, useful answer. This is the entire game.

PART I

The 5 Types of Prompts

Not all prompts are the same. The type of prompt you choose determines the shape of the answer. Here are the five types every AI user must know.

Type 1 — Open-Ended Prompts

Invite the AI to think freely, explore ideas, and give detailed responses. Best used when you want to generate ideas, plans, or in-depth explanations.

USE CASE	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Exploring a Topic	"Explore the future of AI. What are the latest advancements and their impact on society?"
Creating a Guide	"Financial Literacy for Beginners: create a step-by-step guide to understanding investing."
Idea Generation	"Explore different online earning ideas, business models, and passive income potential."
Career Planning	"Map out the different career paths in technology and the skills required for each."

Type 2 — Close-Ended Prompts

Ask for a specific, direct, or factual answer. Great for quick lookups, definitions, and yes/no questions.

USE CASE	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Factual Question	"What is the most widely used programming language in web development?"
Definition	"In AI, what does the acronym ML stand for?"
Formula	"What is the formula for calculating compound interest?"

Type 3 — Multi-Part Prompts

Break a complex question into labelled parts. Forces the AI to address every angle of a topic in a single, organised response.

USE CASE	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Learning a Skill	"Learning Python. Part 1: Choose the best resource. Part 2: Build a daily practice plan. Part 3: Apply with a real project."
Financial Plan	"Financial Independence. Part 1: Set goals. Part 2: Build an emergency fund. Part 3: Long-term investment strategy."
Productivity	"Time Management. Part 1: Diagnose where time is lost. Part 2: Delegation techniques. Part 3: Beating procrastination."

Type 4 — Scenario-Based Prompts

Set a hypothetical scene. The AI steps into that world and answers from inside it. Extremely effective for strategy, planning, and roleplay simulations.

USE CASE	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Career Strategy	"Imagine you are a fresh computer science graduate. Walk me through exactly how you would land your first job in tech."
Content Planning	"You just started a YouTube channel with zero subscribers. Outline your strategy for the first 30 days."

Type 5 — Opinion-Based Prompts

Ask the AI for a viewpoint or analysis, not just facts. Useful for debates, essays, and exploring multiple sides of an argument.

USE CASE	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Tech Analysis	"What is your view on AI's impact on jobs? Is automation a threat or an opportunity for the workforce?"
Education Debate	"Is a formal degree necessary for a career in programming, or can self-learning be equally effective?"

PART II

Practical Prompt Techniques

These four techniques transform basic questions into professional, high-output instructions. Master these and your AI usage will be unrecognisable.

Technique 1 — Role-Playing (The 'Act As' Method)

Tell the AI to become a specific expert. It will adopt that person's knowledge, vocabulary, tone, and way of structuring information. This single technique improves output quality more than almost anything else.

FORMULA

Prompt Formula: "Act as a [role]. [Your task]. Your audience is [audience]. Use [format preferences]."

GOAL	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Blog Writing	"Act as a blogger and write a post about AI tools for small businesses. Tone: friendly and practical. Use headings and bullet points."
Brainstorming	"Act as an expert facilitator. Give me 10 creative ideas for a YouTube channel about personal finance."
Interview Prep	"Act as an HR manager at a top tech company. I am interviewing for a Data Analyst role. Ask me 5 interview questions, then evaluate my answers."
Content Strategy	"Act as a digital marketing strategist. Build a 30-day LinkedIn content plan for an AI education company."

PRO TIP

Pro Tip: The more specific your role, the better the result. "Act as a senior Python developer with 10 years of experience in fintech" will always outperform "Act as a coder".

Technique 2 — Audience & Tone Control

The same information can be explained in a hundred different ways. You control the complexity, tone, and language of every AI response — from explaining to a child to briefing a domain expert.

GOAL	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Simplify for beginners	"[Paste any text] — Explain this to me as if I am a 12-year-old. Use a real-life example."
Professional tone	"Explain this concept in the language of a senior investment banker."
Local language	"[Paste content] — Translate to Hindi. Use a natural, conversational tone."
Clarify a concept	"Break down what compound interest means. Give me one simple example with actual numbers."

Technique 3 — Output Formatting & Optimisation

Tell the AI exactly what format you need — and it will deliver. This is how you turn raw AI output into platform-ready content without extra editing.

GOAL	EXAMPLE PROMPT
YouTube titles	"Suggest 5 YouTube title options for a video about [Topic]. Mix Hindi and English. Add relevant emojis."
SEO description	"Write a 60-word SEO-optimised description for a YouTube video titled: [Title]."
Video hook	"Write a 20-second spoken hook for a video about [Topic]. Make it attention-grabbing. Include a surprising fact."
Social media post	"Write a short LinkedIn post promoting my latest YouTube video: [Title]. Keep it punchy and professional."
Code generation	"Build a JPG to PNG image converter using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Include upload, preview, and download."
Summarising	"[Paste long article] — Summarise the five most important points in plain language."

Technique 4 — Study, Research & Learning Assistance

AI is the most patient tutor you will ever have. It never judges, never rushes, and is available 24 hours a day. Use it to plan your learning, understand difficult concepts, and find resources fast.

GOAL	EXAMPLE PROMPT
Exam preparation	"I have a Physics exam tomorrow on Electromagnetic Induction. Explain all key concepts with examples and give me a technique to remember the formulas."
Build a curriculum	"I want to learn the stock market from absolute beginner to advanced investor. Give me a step-by-step topic list in the correct order."
Find free resources	"I want to learn video editing for free. Recommend the best free courses, YouTube channels, and practice exercises."
Generate ideas	"Suggest 10 unique and specific video ideas for a YouTube channel focused on AI tools for Indian students."
Curated tools list	"Give me a list of 8 AI tools specifically useful for graphic designers. Include what each one does."

STUDY PROMPT CHECKLIST

How to get the best study answers:

1. Tell the AI your current level ("I am a beginner" / "I have basic knowledge")
2. Tell it your goal ("I want to understand" / "I need to memorise" / "I want to apply")
3. Ask it to use examples — abstract explanations are harder to retain

PART III

Advanced Setup & AI Productivity Tools

These setup steps and tools make every AI session faster, smarter, and more personalised — before you even type your first prompt.

Custom Instructions — Set It Once, Benefit Every Time

Most AI tools allow you to set permanent instructions that apply to every conversation. This means the AI already understands your context before you begin.

SETTING	WHAT TO WRITE
About You	Your name, job, goals, and interests. Example: "I am an AI educator based in India. My audience is college students and MSME owners. I build AI automation workflows for businesses."
Response Style	Tone, format, language preferences. Example: "Always respond in short paragraphs. If I write in Hinglish, reply in Hinglish. Avoid unnecessary filler sentences. Be direct."

Useful AI Extensions & Productivity Tools

These tools sit on top of your AI and multiply what it can do:

- AIPRM for ChatGPT**
 Thousands of expert-built, ready-to-use prompts across every category. One click to activate — no writing needed.
- WebChatGPT**
 Connects the AI to live internet search. Eliminates outdated responses by pulling in real-time information.
- ChatGPT Writer**
 Write professional emails and messages in seconds. Works across Gmail and other platforms.
- YouTube Summary with ChatGPT**
 Get a full summary of any YouTube video instantly. Extract key insights without watching the entire video.



Voice Control for ChatGPT

Talk to the AI hands-free. Converts your voice to text and reads responses aloud — perfect for multitasking.

PART IV

The World-Building Method

This is the most important concept in this entire guide. Understanding this will completely change how you use AI.

The Problem: 99% of People Prompt Wrong

Most people ask vague, generic questions. The AI responds with vague, generic answers. This is not the AI's fault — it simply goes to the most common, average version of the world it knows. Every output looks the same.

LAZY PROMPT

"There is a world with giant creatures. What are they?"

Result:

Trolls. Cyclops. Ogres.

Generic. Forgettable.

WORLD-BUILT PROMPT

"A world of sand. Moisture is scarce. People wear suits to absorb it. Clans war over a resource in the sand."

Result: Sandworms. Unique.

The difference? The second prompt builds a specific world. The AI fills in the missing piece — the creature — using only the context you gave it. The more puzzle pieces you provide, the more precise and unique the output.

How to Build the World: 4 Questions to Ask Yourself

Who is the audience?

A student, a CEO, a beginner, an expert?

What is the exact goal?

Explain, generate, summarise, persuade, compare?

What constraints apply?

Length, format, tone, language, platform?

What context does the AI need?

Industry, background, prior knowledge, examples?

PART V

9 Advanced Prompting Techniques

These methods separate casual AI users from power users. Learn these and you will consistently produce output that others cannot replicate.

01 If/Then Prompts

Define the AI's exact behaviour with conditional logic. This is how AI agents and chatbots are programmed to handle different situations.

- "If the user asks for harmful content, decline politely and explain why."
- "If the user asks about pricing, redirect them to the contact page."

02 Deep Research — The Red Pill Approach

When analysing long content, don't ask for a summary — ask for insights. Three-part structure: (1) General summary (2) Non-obvious insights (3) Actionable steps.

- "Summarise this book. Then give me 3 insights most people miss. Then tell me how to apply each one."

03 The Breakdown Prompt

Deconstruct complex statements into their real components. This is how you find opportunities that others overlook.

- "A AAA game costs \$100M. Break down exactly where that money goes."
- "Now compare those roles at US salaries vs. Indian salaries."

04 Meta-Prompting — AI Prompts AI

Use one AI to write a better prompt for another AI. Especially powerful for image generation and complex design briefs.

- "Here is my world: [description]. Write me a detailed Midjourney prompt for a flower in this world."
- "I want a page like Stripe. Break it into every individual component with visual details."

05 Persona & Study Modes

The AI can adopt any voice or expertise level. Use this for both learning and generating content in a specific style.

- "Teach me how transformers work. First as if I am 10 years old. Then as a CS undergrad. Then as a researcher."
- "Write this section in the style of Paul Graham — clear, direct, slightly contrarian."

06 The Gap Finder — AI as Personal Coach

Use AI to honestly identify what you don't know. This is one of the most underused techniques — and one of the most valuable for learning.

- "Based on our conversation, what gaps do you see in my knowledge or reasoning?"
- "Given what I have shared about my interests, what should I learn next and why?"

07 Enforcing Confidence — Reducing Hallucinations

AI sometimes states incorrect facts with full confidence. Force it to rate its own certainty so you know what to verify.

- "Answer the following question only if you are confident. Give a confidence score (0-100%) for every fact you state."
- Rule of thumb: below 70% confidence — verify independently before using the data.

08 Erasing the AI Stain — Developing a Unique Voice

Generic AI writing is instantly recognisable. Use these techniques to produce original content that does not read like a machine wrote it.

- Negative Rule: "Never use phrases like 'it is important to note' or 'in today's world'. Be direct."
- Style Blending: "Write with the clarity of Richard Feynman and the energy of Gary Vaynerchuk."
- Corpus Dumping: Paste your own past writing, then say: "Match this person's style exactly."

09 Emotional & Forceful Prompting

Unusual — but it works. Emotional language causes the model to use more processing steps, which often improves accuracy on complex tasks.

- "Take a deep breath and think step by step before answering."
- "This answer is going into a presentation for senior executives. Be precise and thorough."

FINAL PRINCIPLE

The best prompt engineers are not technical wizards — they are clear thinkers. The skill is not knowing commands, it is knowing exactly what you want and being able to describe it precisely.

PART VI

Running AI Locally — The Student Hack

Cloud AI tools like ChatGPT have monthly fees and usage limits. If that is a constraint, there is a fully legitimate solution: run open-source AI models directly on your own computer.

The Solution

Download and run open-source models like Llama 3, Mistral, or Phi directly on your laptop using a free tool called Ollama. No API key needed. No subscription. No internet required.

What You Need

A modern laptop — ideally with 8GB+ RAM and a dedicated GPU or NPU (Neural Processing Unit). The more powerful the hardware, the faster the model runs.

What You Get

Completely unlimited usage. No token limits. No monthly caps. No running meter. Build, experiment, break things, and rebuild — 24 hours a day, at zero cost.

Quick Reference — 9 Techniques at a Glance

TECHNIQUE	BEST USED FOR
01 If/Then Prompts	AI agents, chatbots, system behaviour control
02 Red Pill Research	Extracting deep insight from books and reports
03 Breakdown Prompt	Deconstructing costs, industries, and systems
04 Meta-Prompting	Image generation, complex UI and design briefs
05 Persona & Study Modes	Learning, writing in specific styles and voices
06 Gap Finder	Self-improvement and knowledge mapping
07 Confidence Scoring	Fact-checking and data-heavy research
08 Erase the AI Stain	Unique content creation and personal writing
09 Emotional Prompting	Improving accuracy on complex analytical tasks

AIMANTRAAS

AI Education & Automation

We help businesses, colleges & professionals deploy and master AI.

From AI upskilling to production-grade agents — real systems, not demos.

AI UPSKILLING

Structured programs for colleges, corporates & working professionals.

AI AGENT MARKETPLACE

Production-grade agents built to exact client specifications.

ENTERPRISE AUTOMATION

End-to-end AI deployments for businesses. Real ROI. Deployable from day one.

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